



PEDESTRIANS pass businesses in Altadena destroyed by the Eaton fire. The Jan. 7 blaze claimed 19 lives.

Deadly Eaton fire ignited by SoCal Edison, feds allege

Federal prosecutors on Thursday sued Southern California Edison over its alleged role in the deadly Eaton fire, a blaze that killed 19 people and destroyed more than 9,000 homes and other structures in Altadena and the surrounding area.

In a civil complaint, prosecutors allege that the Eaton fire was ignited by “faulty power infrastructure or by sparks from faulty power infrastructure owned, maintained, and operated” by Edison.

The results of the official investigation into the fire by the Los Angeles

Prosecutors seek tens of millions of dollars in damages for January blaze and one in 2022

By Brittny Mejia and Melody Petersen

County Fire Department and California Department of Forestry and Fire Protection have not yet been announced. The government’s lawsuit notes that the investigation into the fire remains ongoing.

The government also sued Edison on Thursday for its alleged role in the Fairview fire, which burned near Hemet in 2022. Prosecutors are seeking tens of millions of dollars in damages from Edison, alleging the company’s negligence caused both fires.

Together, the fires burned tens of

[See Eaton fire, A7]

COVID cases surge as vaccine access is limited

Doctors, pharmacists say federal guidance will discourage some from getting the shot.

By RONG-GONG LIN II

Every year around this time, like clockwork, Marty Lazniarz would plan to get his regular COVID-19 vaccine — essential protection before heading out on a trip.

But this year, trying to get his routine shot has been anything but.

The 70-year-old retiree from Long Beach said it has been frustratingly difficult to get a COVID vaccine on time this year because of how the Trump administration has effectively postponed delivery of the shots, and made it harder for people to get them.

“The amount of confusion surrounding availability of the new vaccine has been maddening,” said Lazniarz, who lost his best friend to COVID a year and a half ago.

He’s far from the only one who is upset. Doctors and pharmacists report they are being inundated with questions about the uncertainty surrounding the long-available vaccines this fall.

Fueling that is the recent announcement from the Department of Health and Human Services, led by the vac-

cine skeptic Robert F. Kennedy Jr., that adults under 65 will have to consult with a healthcare professional or, in some states, attest that they have an underlying medical condition before they can get the updated version of the COVID vaccination this fall.

Parents this year are also required to talk to a healthcare professional before their children can be vaccinated.

Kennedy previously said the guidance would “keep vaccines available to people

[See Vaccine, A6]

Kennedy faces rare bipartisan rebuke at hearing

By ANA CEBALLOS

Robert F. Kennedy Jr., the nation’s Health secretary and a longtime vaccine skeptic, struck a defiant tone Thursday as he faced bipartisan criticism over changes he has made to reorganize federal health agencies and vaccine policies, telling senators that he is determined to “eliminate politics from science.”

In the testy appearance before the Senate Finance Committee, Kennedy repeatedly defended his record in heated exchanges with senators from both parties and questioned data that show the effectiveness of vaccines. In turn, senators accused him of taking actions that contradict his promise seven months earlier that he would do “nothing that makes it difficult or discourages people from taking vaccines.”

“Secretary Kennedy, in your confirmation hearing you promised to uphold the highest standard for vaccines. Since then, I’ve grown

[See Kennedy, A6]

UC warns that Trump cuts could be crippling

System president says financial losses might run in the billions and reach beyond UCLA.

By JAWED KALEEM

The University of California’s top leader has raised the “distinct possibility” that financial losses due to the Trump administration’s funding cuts could amount to billions of dollars and extend beyond UCLA to the entire 10-campus system, telling state legislators Wednesday that “the stakes are high and the risks are

very real.”

In a letter to dozens of lawmakers obtained by The Times, UC President James B. Milliken said the university is facing “one of the gravest threats in UC’s 157-year history” after the Trump administration cut off more than \$500 million in grants to UCLA before demanding a \$1.2-billion fine over allegations of campus antisemitism.

Milliken outlined the potential losses at the nation’s preeminent public university system under Trump’s higher education agenda in his strongest and most detailed public words since starting the job Aug. 1,

days after funding troubles hit UCLA.

UC “receives over \$17 billion per year from the federal government — \$9.9 billion in Medicare and Medicaid funding, \$5.7 billion in research funding, and \$1.9 billion in student financial aid per year,” Milliken wrote in the letter addressed to Sen. Scott Wiener (D-San Francisco), chair of the Joint Legislative Budget Committee.

If such funds were lost, Milliken wrote, “we would need at least \$4-5 billion per year to minimize the damage.”

“A substantial loss of federal funding would devastate our university and

[See UC, A7]



MYUNG J. CHUN Los Angeles Times

THE TRUMP administration demands a \$1.2-billion fine from UCLA, alleging antisemitism on campus.



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LEGENDARY TASTEMAKER

Giorgio Armani preferred straight lines, subtle curves and fluid fabrics.

GIORGIO ARMANI, 1934 - 2025

Italian designer revolutionized shape of fashion for decades

By MARY ROURKE

Giorgio Armani, the Italian designer who cut the stuffing out of men’s heavily constructed suits for a softer yet sophisticated look that revolutionized the shape of fashion for men and women for decades to come, has died at home, his fashion house confirmed Thursday on social media. He was 91.

“Il Signor Armani, as he was always respectfully and admirably called by employees and collaborators, passed away peacefully, surrounded by his loved ones,” his team

said on Instagram. “Indefatigable to the end, he worked until his final days, dedicating himself to the company, the collections, and the many ongoing and future projects.”

Armani expanded fashion to all aspects of life, his team said, “anticipating the times with extraordinary clarity and pragmatism.” He established an open dialogue with the public and was mindful of the needs of the community, “especially in support of his beloved Milan,” the team said.

Armani came onto the fashion scene in the mid-1970s with a small menswear collection that broke all the rules. The centerpiece of his line soon became an executive class

[See Armani, A8]

In California, job losses mount amid uncertainty and AI’s rise

By QUEENIE WONG

Job cuts so far this year have already surpassed the total for 2024, as government cost-cutting, economic uncertainty and AI have prompted employers to reduce staff.

California and the tech industry have been particularly hard hit, according to a report Thursday from Challenger, Gray & Christmas, a company that helps people pivot to new careers and monitors job cut announcements by U.S. companies.

In the eight months through August, U.S. companies announced about

892,000 cuts. That’s 66% more than a year earlier and above the total for all of 2024. The last time the cut tally was higher was in the middle of COVID-19 pandemic lockdowns in 2020.

The Trump administration’s initiative to cut government spending — through what it calls the Department of Government Efficiency, also known as DOGE — was the biggest culprit for the slashing of government jobs, while economic concerns and technological change weighed on sectors including tech, finance and retail.

“After the impact of DOGE on the Federal Gov-

ernment, employers are citing economic and market factors as the driver of layoffs,” Andrew Challenger, senior vice president and labor expert for Challenger, Gray & Christmas, said in a statement.

California was the state with the most cuts, surpassed only by Washington, D.C. The technology industry had the most cuts in California, followed by services, media, healthcare and retail.

California’s cuts this year increased 24% to 135,241. Washington saw a tripling of cuts to 294,696. Job cuts rose 33% in New York but fell in

[See Jobs, A12]

Newsom adds up deployment costs

President’s decision to send National Guard troops to L.A. cost taxpayers \$120 million, says governor. CALIFORNIA, B1

Hernández hopes to turn it around

Dodgers outfielder is having one of the worst seasons of his career. Is there time for redemption? SPORTS, B10

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GINA FERRAZZI Los Angeles Times

TEOSCAR Hernández endured injuries, slumps and defensive miscues.

TIFF still a hit on awards circuit

The Toronto International Film Festival has something for everyone, one of several reasons it remains vital 50 years on. ENTERTAINMENT, E1

Weather Mostly sunny. L.A. Basin: 86/64. B6

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